PassFrame tuition

Writing Technique

Year 4 Pt 2 — 11+ Lesson Worksheet (PassFrame Tuition)

Worked examples — tutor talks through these first

Easy: What technique is used in "The fire danced and flickered in the dark"?
Method & answer: Personification — the fire is given the human action of dancing.

Standard: Which is more powerful: "The cake was nice" or "The cake oozed with rich, gooey chocolate"?
Method & answer: The second — it uses a powerful verb and sensory detail rather than the plain, vague description.

Advanced: Identify TWO techniques in: "The icy wind bit like a thousand tiny needles."
Method & answer: Simile ("like a thousand tiny needles") and a powerful verb/personification ("bit" — giving the wind a biting action).

Easy / Standard — *work through together, answer 5 in the lesson* ⏱ *15 min (1 min per question)*

1. Which technique is used in "The fire danced and flickered in the dark"? A) simile B) metaphor C) personification D) onomatopoeia

2. What is the name of the technique that repeats the same starting sound in a sentence?

3. Identify the technique: "The bell rang, clanging loudly through the school."

4. Which sentence uses a simile? A) Her eyes were emeralds. B) Her eyes sparkled like emeralds. C) Her eyes sparkled brightly. D) Her eyes were green.

5. Write a simile to describe a tall building.

6. What technique is used in "The frogs croaked and ribbited by the pond"? Explain why it works well.

7. Underline the powerful verb and explain why it's better than 'ate': "He devoured his dinner in seconds."

8. Which sentence is an example of alliteration? A) Cheeky chimps chattered cheerfully. B) The monkey climbed a tree. C) It was a hot day. D) She read a book.

9. Select ALL the sentences that use personification: A) The trees bent their heads in the storm. B) The rain fell heavily. C) The camera flashed brightly. D) The angry sea swallowed the tiny boat.

10. Choose the better-written sentence and explain why: A) "The cake was nice." B) "The cake oozed with rich, gooey chocolate."

11. What technique is used in "The snake hissed menacingly"? Name it.

12. Write a metaphor to describe a busy street.

13. Which sentence begins with a preposition phrase for variety? A) Under the bright stars, they camped. B) They camped under the bright stars. C) They camped outside. D) The stars were bright.

14. Identify the technique used in this sentence: "The waves reached out and grabbed her ankles."

15. Select ALL the words below that are powerful adjectives rather than plain, overused ones: A) nice B) glorious C) good D) magnificent

Standard — *work through together, answer 5 in the lesson* ⏱ *15 min (1 min per question)*

1. What is the difference between alliteration and onomatopoeia?

6. Select ALL the sentences below that use onomatopoeia: A) The

11. Identify TWO techniques used in this sentence: "The icy wind bit like

Give one example of each.

2. Which sentence uses a metaphor (not a simile)? A) The playground was as loud as a zoo. B) The playground sounded like a zoo. C) The playground was a zoo. D) The playground seemed like a zoo.

3. Identify the technique and explain its effect: "The floor creaked with every step."

4. Rewrite this sentence to include a powerful verb instead of 'went': "The cat went across the fence."

5. Which sentence shows rather than tells the reader a character is tired? A) Leo was tired. B) Leo felt exhausted. C) Leo's eyelids drooped and his head nodded forward. D) Leo was sleepy.

bacon sizzled in the pan. B) The bacon was crispy. C) The door slammed shut. D) The door was closed.

7. Write a sentence using personification to describe an old, creaking ship.

8. Which technique is used in "Sally sold seashells by the seashore"? A) simile B) alliteration C) metaphor D) onomatopoeia

9. Explain why starting a sentence with "Without a sound," is more effective than "There was no sound and the cat crept forward."

10. Choose the better-written sentence and explain why: A) "The dragon was scary." B) "Smoke curled from the dragon's nostrils as it bared its jagged teeth."

a thousand tiny needles."

12. Which sentence opens with an -ing clause (fronted participle) for variety? A) Racing against time, she sprinted to the finish line. B) She sprinted to the finish line, racing against time. C) She was racing against time. D) Time was racing against her.

13. Select ALL the sentence openers below that add variety: A) Nervously, he opened the letter. B) He opened the letter nervously. C) Without hesitation, she dived in. D) She dived in without hesitation.

14. Write a sentence that 'shows' a character is proud, without using the word 'proud'.

15. Identify the technique and explain why the writer chose it: "The engine coughed and spluttered before finally starting."

Standard / Hard — *work through together, answer 5 in the lesson* ⏱ *15 min (1 min per question)*

1. What is the difference between a simile and personification? Give one example of each.

2. Which sentence contains BOTH alliteration and a powerful verb? A) The furious flames flickered fiercely. B) The fire was hot and bright. C) The fire burned all night. D) The fire was dangerous.

3. Explain the effect of the powerful verb "plummeted" in: "The stone

6. Select ALL the techniques used in this sentence: "The ancient oak stretched its gnarled arms towards the sky, whispering secrets to the wind." A) simile B) personification C) metaphor D) onomatopoeia

7. Identify the technique and explain why it is particularly effective here: "Fear gripped her by the throat."

8. Which sentence opens with a subordinate clause for variety? A)

11. Select ALL the sentences below that use powerful, precise verbs instead of the overused verb 'walked': A) He stumbled through the wreckage. B) He walked through the wreckage. C) She strolled along the beach. D) She walked along the beach.

12. Identify the technique used in "The news spread like wildfire" and explain its effect.

13. Which sentence uses onomatopoeia to build tension? A)

plummeted into the deep ravine."

Although the bridge looked unsafe, they crossed it anyway. B) They crossed the bridge although it looked unsafe. C) The bridge looked unsafe but they crossed it. D) Unsafe though it was, crossing it, they did.

The floorboards groaned in the silence. B) The floorboards were old. C) He walked on the floorboards. D) The floorboards needed fixing.

4. Rewrite this 'telling' sentence as a 'showing' sentence: "The boy was excited about the party."

9. Explain the difference in effect between these two openers: A) "The city was busy." B) "Horns blared, crowds surged, and neon lights blazed against the night sky."

14. Explain why combining a metaphor and alliteration makes this sentence effective: "The midnight monster mercilessly murdered the silence."

5. Which of these two sentences is more effective, and why? A) "The market was busy and colourful." B) "Stalls burst with colour as traders bellowed their prices over the crowd's roar."

10. Write two sentences describing a desert: one using a simile, one using personification.

15. Choose the better-written paragraph opener and explain why, considering sentence variety and technique: A) "It was foggy. The street was empty. It felt strange." B) "Fog curled around the empty street like ghostly fingers, and an eerie silence pressed down on everything."